

INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Preparation is the key. Knowing in advance what questions the interviewer may ask will give you greater self-confidence. Try to understand from the employer's point of view why the questions are asked. You will have a productive interview when you understand how to respond to these questions in a way that meets the employer's needs. Demonstrating a positive attitude is also important. Following are the most commonly asked interview questions.

1. How are you today? Fine thank you, how are you?
2. Tell me about yourself. (Don't volunteer personal information.) Summarize your work history, education, and skills including transferable skills.
3. What qualifications make you a good candidate for this position? Provide more detail regarding work history, education, and skills.
4. Why do you want to work here? (Build employer's ego.) Good reputation, good working conditions, treat your employees well, quality work or products.
5. What would your last boss say about your work performance? Try to use something positive they said, if there isn't anything positive then be honest but indicate that you have learned from your mistakes and demonstrate this with an example. "My last boss was unhappy with my attendance, I realized I was late more often than I thought so I have made this a priority and I can honestly say that I haven't been late to any of my classes (or work) since then."
6. What two or three accomplishments have given you the most satisfaction? Why? Select accomplishments that illustrate your skills best and avoid those that might raise red flags such as children.
7. What caused your last job to end? You must be honest but never denigrate your past employer. Reasons might include: "I quit to attend college full-time", "I took another position that offered me more hours", "I was let go because of my attendance but I have since acquired reliable transportation so this is no longer an issue."
8. What are your personal strengths? These are also called self-management skills i.e. dependable, prompt, hard-working, reliable, fast-learner, flexible, etc. These qualities make you a good employee anywhere.
9. What are your weaknesses? Think of something that could also have positive aspects such as "Sometimes I'm stubborn but you'll find that if you give me a job to do, I stick with it until it's done", "Sometimes I am quiet but I feel that makes me a better listener", "My friends say I'm a perfectionist but I have learned how to balance this quality with the need to meet deadlines as well." You might also choose something that you can demonstrate you have changed such as tardiness, organization, etc.
10. Do you prefer working alone or with others? I am able to work alone on projects or as part of a team.
11. How do you deal with stress or pressure? "I have found that I work well under pressure or deadlines, I prioritize my tasks and utilize stress or pressure to motivate me." Many like to say "I take a break" but this may not always be practical, usually the stress is because you don't have time to take a break.
12. What kind of supervision do you like best? "I like a supervisor who is fair, friendly, knows the business and is willing to listen to new ideas." "I like a supervisor who gives me a job to do, let's me do it, and is there if I have any questions."

(Over Please)

13. What do you want to be doing five years from now? Don't say I want your job. "I'd like to get this position and grow within the company."
14. Have you ever had a conflict with a boss or instructor? How did you resolve it? They want examples of how you deal with conflict not that you haven't had any. If not boss or instructor what about family members? Use the situation, task, action, result (STAR) technique.
15. What two or three things are most important to you in your job? Not pay or benefits but maybe being appreciated for the work you do, stability, positive work environment, etc.
16. What do you think it takes for an employee to make progress within a company? Being on time, hard work, commitment to quality or customers, being able to train others, etc.
17. Describe a situation where others you were working with on a project disagreed with your ideas. What did you do? Use the STAR technique. Describe the situation in as neutral terms as possible.
18. Give an example of when you had to work with someone who was difficult to get along with. Why was this person difficult? How did you handle that person? STAR technique. Describe the situation in as neutral terms as possible.
19. Where does this job fit with your career goals? This is the perfect opportunity for me to start and build my career with your organization.
20. Do you have any health problems which might affect your ability to handle this job? No, I am in good health. The key is whether they affect your ability to handle the job. If you require an accommodation you can choose at what point you wish to discuss this.
21. What do you expect for a starting wage? "Of course I'm interested in a job that pays well, but I am also interested in doing a job that interests me. What would you pay someone with my experience and qualifications?" IF they won't name a figure do your research with wage surveys available from any state employment agency.
22. I've interviewed several people for this position. Why should I hire you? Summarize your work history, your education, and transferable skills.
23. When could you start, if hired? If you are working it is generally best practice to provide your current employer two week's notice (if employed full-time).
24. Do you have any questions? Save the what's-in-it-for-me questions regarding pay, benefits, holidays, etc. until after you are offered the job. This is where you use the research you did on the company to ask relevant questions regarding products or growth. You might ask why the position is vacant, could you have a tour of the facility, how long is the training period etc.